

Word family: **ride / rides / rode / ridden / riding / rider / ridership**

Base word: ride

Past tense: rode

Past participle: ridden

ing form: riding

Related forms: rider, ridership

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “We used to play football in the park, trade comic books, and **ride our bicycles** around the housing estate until sunset.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **ride** means to **travel on and control a bicycle while sitting on it**.

The speaker and Ryan used to cycle around their housing estate together.

繁體中文： **坐在單車上並操控它前進；踩單車 / 騎單車**

中文翻譯：

> “...and **ride our bicycles** around the housing estate until sunset.”

「.....還會在屋苑裡**踩 / 騎單車**，一直玩到太陽下山。」

Here:

ride a bicycle = 坐在單車上並操控它前進

1. **ride + bicycle/motorcycle/horse (單車 / 電單車 / 馬匹) — 騎 ; 乘騎**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To sit on and travel using a bicycle, motorcycle, horse, or similar means of transport, usually while controlling or balancing it.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We used to **ride our bicycles** around the housing estate.”

「我們以前會在屋苑裡**踩 / 騎單車**。」

Practice 2

> “She learned to **ride a horse** when she was young.”

「她年輕時學會了**騎馬**。」

Practice 3

> “He **rides a motorcycle** to work.”

「他每天**騎電單車**上班。」

****ride something = 坐在某種需要乘坐、平衡或操控的交通工具 / 動物上前進****

Common:

- * ride a bicycle
- * ride a bike
- * ride a motorcycle
- * ride a horse
- * ride a scooter

These belong to one underlying ****travel while mounted on something**** sense.

2. ****ride + bus/train/etc. (交通工具) — 乘坐****

****Ride**** can also mean travelling as a passenger in public or private transport.

Practice 4

> “We **rode the bus** into the city.”

「我們**乘巴士**進城。」

Practice 5

> “She **rides the train** to work every morning.”

「她每天早上都**乘火車**上班。」

****ride + vehicle = 乘坐交通工具前往某地****

This is especially common in American English.

British English often prefers:

> **take the bus/train**

or:

> **travel by bus/train**

For core counting, I would normally **merge** this with Meaning 1 under the broad concept:

> **travel while being carried by an animal or vehicle**

The learner-facing Chinese changes from **騎** to **乘坐**, but the broad semantic concept remains similar.

3. **ride** = journey/trip in or on a vehicle/animal (名詞) — 車程 ; 乘坐旅程 ; 騎行

As a noun, **a ride** means a journey made in or on a vehicle, bicycle, horse, etc.

Practice 6

> “The bus **ride** takes about forty minutes.”

「這段巴士**車程**大約需要四十分鐘。」

Practice 7

> “We went for a long bike **ride** after lunch.”

「午飯後我們去了一趟長途**單車騎行**。」

a ride = 乘坐交通工具、騎單車或騎乘動物所進行的一段旅程

The natural Chinese depends on the transport:

* bus ride → 車程

* bike ride → 單車騎行

* horse ride → 騎馬活動 / 旅程

4. **give someone a ride / get a ride** (搭車) — 載某人一程 ; 乘別人的車

Especially in American English, ****ride**** can mean transportation provided by another person in their vehicle.

Practice 8

> “Can you give me a ****ride**** to the station?”

「你可以****載我去車站 / 順便載我一程****嗎？」

Practice 9

> “I got a ****ride**** home from a colleague.”

「我讓同事****載我回家****。」

****give someone a ride = 用自己的車載某人前往某個地方****

****get a ride = 乘坐別人的車前往某地****

This corresponds closely to British English:

> ****give someone a lift****

Since ****lift**** was already curated, this is a particularly useful contrast.

5. ****ride = amusement/theme-park attraction (遊樂設施) — 機動遊戲；遊樂設施****

As a noun, ****ride**** can mean a machine or attraction at a fairground, amusement park, or theme park that carries and entertains passengers.

Practice 10

> “That roller coaster is the most popular ****ride**** in the park.”

「那座過山車是樂園裡最受歡迎的****機動遊戲 / 遊樂設施****。」

Practice 11

> “The children wanted to go on every ****ride****.”

「孩子們想把所有****機動遊戲****都玩一遍。」

****a ride = 在主題樂園、嘉年華等地方載着乘客移動並提供娛樂刺激的遊樂設施****

This is genuinely different from an ordinary journey.

6. **ride = quality/experience of travelling in a vehicle (行車感受) — 乘坐感 ; 行車舒適度**

A **ride** can also mean the physical experience of travelling in a particular vehicle, especially how smooth, rough, comfortable, etc. it feels.

Practice 12

> “The new suspension gives the car a smoother **ride**.”

「新的懸掛系統令這部車的**行車感 / 乘坐感**更加平穩。」

Practice 13

> “The journey was long, but the **ride** was comfortable.”

「旅程雖然很長，但**乘坐感**很舒適。」

****ride = 乘坐某輛車時所感受到的平穩度、舒適度或整體行車體驗****

This develops from the journey sense but shifts the focus from:

> ****the trip itself****

to:

> ****how the trip physically feels****

I would show it explicitly but probably merge it with the noun journey sense for strict core counting.

7. ****ride + wave/current/etc. (移動表面 / 力量) — 順勢乘着 ; 隨.....移動****

****Ride**** can extend to being carried or moving successfully with a wave, current, or similar moving force.

Practice 14

> “The surfer ****rode the wave**** all the way to the shore.”

「衝浪者一路****乘着浪****滑到岸邊。」

Practice 15

> “The bird ****rode**** the warm air currents above the valley.”

「那隻鳥****乘着暖氣流****在山谷上空滑翔。」

****ride something = 借助正在移動的波浪、氣流或其他力量，跟隨它向前移動****

This is closely related to the broader physical meaning:

> ****be carried by something while remaining on/in it****

So I would normally merge it into Meaning 1 rather than create a separate major sense.

8. ****ride someone (非正式) — 不斷批評 / 催迫某人****

In informal American English, ****ride**** can mean repeatedly criticizing, bothering, or putting pressure on someone.

Practice 16

> “My coach kept ****riding**** me about my mistakes.”

「教練一直因我的錯誤而****不停責備 / 催迫我****。」

Practice 17

> “Stop ****riding**** him—he already knows what went wrong.”

「別再****不停責備 / 逼他****了，他已經知道哪裡出了問題。」

****ride someone = 不斷批評、催促或給某人壓力；非正式，尤其美式英語****

This is a genuinely different figurative meaning, although it is lower-priority than the common transport senses.

Related form: ****rider****

The basic meaning of ****rider**** is a person riding something.

Practice 18

> “The bicycle ****rider**** was wearing a helmet.”

「那名****單車騎手****戴着頭盔。」

Practice 19

> “She is an experienced horse ****rider****.”

「她是一位經驗豐富的****騎馬者 / 騎手****。」

****rider = 騎乘單車、電單車、馬匹等的人****

Related form: ****ridership****

****Ridership**** is especially common in transport planning.

It means the number of passengers using a public transport service.

Practice 20

> “Rail ****ridership**** increased last year.”

「去年鐵路的****乘客量 / 搭乘人次****增加了。」

Practice 21

> “The new route attracted higher ****ridership****.”

「新路線吸引了更多****乘客 / 搭乘人次****。」

****ridership = 在某段時間內使用公共交通服務的乘客人數或搭乘量****

This is especially common in North American English.

Fixed expression: ****go for a ride — 去兜風 / 乘車遊玩****

Practice 22

> “We went for a ****ride**** along the coast.”

「我們沿海岸****兜風 / 乘車遊玩****。」

Practice 23

> “Do you want to go for a bike **ride**?”

「你想不想去**踩一會兒單車**？」

go for a ride = 以乘車、騎單車、騎馬等作休閒活動，通常旅程本身就是目的

Fixed expression: **free ride** — 不勞而獲的好處

This is a common figurative expression.

Practice 24

> “Nobody should expect a **free ride**.”

「沒有人應該期望可以**不付出便得到好處 / 不勞而獲**。」

Practice 25

> “He has worked hard and never asked for a **free ride**.”

「他一直很努力，從沒有要求過**不勞而獲的待遇**。」

a free ride = 不需要付出相應成本、努力或責任便得到利益

This is an idiom rather than a new core meaning of bare **ride**.

Fixed construction: **a lot rides on something** — 很大程度取決於.....

Practice 26

> “A lot **rides on** the final interview.”

「很多事情都**取決於**最後那次面試。」

Practice 27

> “The future of the project **rides on** this decision.”

「這個項目的未來**取決於**這項決定。」

****something rides on something = 某個結果、成功或未來很大程度取決於另一件事情****

This is a figurative fixed construction and should not inflate the core meaning count.

Important distinction: ****ride vs drive****

This is one of the most important learner contrasts.

****ride****

normally means:

- * be transported on/in something;
- * ride a bicycle, motorcycle, horse, etc.

****drive****

normally means:

- * control a car, bus, truck, etc.

> “I ****rode**** in the car.”

= 我乘坐那部車。

> “I ****drove**** the car.”

= 我駕駛那部車。

But:

> ****ride a bicycle**** 

not normally:

> ****drive a bicycle**** 

Important distinction: ****ride vs cycle****

****ride a bicycle****

is broad everyday English.

cycle

specifically means travel by bicycle.

> “We rode our bicycles around the estate.”

> “We cycled around the estate.”

Both are natural.

Cycle is more specific; **ride** applies to many more forms of transport and animals.

Important distinction: **ride** vs **take**

With public transport:

American English commonly:

> ride the bus

> ride the subway

British English commonly:

> take the bus

> take the train

Both refer to using the transport service, but regional preference differs.

Important distinction: **ride** vs **lift**

For receiving transport from another person:

American English

> give someone a **ride**

British English

> give someone a **lift**

Both mean:

> **順便載某人一程**

This is especially useful because **lift** has already been mapped in your database.

Important distinction: **ride vs trip**

ride

focuses on the experience/journey while being transported.

trip

is broader and can include:

- * travelling there;
- * time spent at the destination;
- * returning;
- * the overall excursion.

> “The train ride took two hours.”

= 火車車程兩小時。

> “The trip to Tokyo lasted five days.”

= 東京之旅五天。

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **ride**
- * **rides**
- * **rode**
- * **ridden**
- * **riding**
- * **rider**
- * **ridership**

Useful expressions include:

- * ride a bicycle
- * ride a horse
- * ride the bus
- * go for a ride
- * give someone a ride
- * amusement ride
- * smooth ride
- * free ride
- * ride a wave
- * a lot rides on something

Under the Golden Manual, useful modern constructions and related forms should be checked broadly, while contexts sharing one underlying semantic idea should be merged conservatively.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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ride — travel on/in animal or vehicle	坐在單車、電單車、馬匹或交通工具上 / 內，讓它載着自己移動；視情況譯作騎 / 乘坐
ride — noun, journey	乘坐交通工具、騎單車或騎乘動物所進行的一段旅程
give/get a ride	用自己的車載某人一程 / 乘坐別人的車前往某地
ride — amusement attraction	在主題樂園、嘉年華等地方載着乘客移動並提供娛樂刺激的遊樂設施
ride — travelling quality	乘坐某輛車時所感受到的平穩度、舒適度或整體行車體驗
ride a wave/current	借助正在移動的波浪、氣流等力量並隨其前進；與廣義「乘着移動」概念相關
ride someone — informal	不斷批評、催促、騷擾或向某人施加壓力
rider	騎乘單車、電單車、馬匹等的人
ridership	某段時間內使用公共交通服務的乘客數量 / 搭乘人次

For your original sentence

> “...and ****ride our bicycles**** around the housing estate until sunset.”

The exact meaning is:

****ride = 坐在單車上並操控、平衡它前進****

So:

> ****ride our bicycles****

= ****踩 / 騎我們的單車****

For your database, I would count **5 genuinely useful core meanings** for **ride**:

1. **travel on/in a bicycle, motorcycle, horse, vehicle, etc.**
2. **noun — a journey made while being transported**
3. **give/get a ride — transport in someone else's vehicle**
4. **noun — amusement-park/fairground attraction**
5. **informal verb — repeatedly criticize or pressure someone**

I would merge **ride a wave/current** into #1 as a physical extension, merge **smooth/rough ride** into the noun journey family, and treat **free ride** and **a lot rides on something** as fixed figurative expressions rather than inflate the core count.